COLLEGE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (CBA)

College Officers

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History and Overview

Being the first and oldest college of the University, the College of Business Administration (CBA) at Rafik Hariri University was established in 1999. Since then, the College has grown significantly and now offers six undergraduate business programs: Accounting, Business IT Management, Finance and Banking, Human Resources Management, Management, Marketing, and Advertising. In addition, the College offers a graduate MBA program in general business administration. Moreover, the CBA takes pride in being the first in Lebanon and the Arab World to offer a graduate MBA program in Oil and Gas Management.

The faculty is active in applied research across several business domains and related areas, focusing on developing solutions to real-world community problems. To that end, and in partnership with governmental entities, civil society, trade associations, and the private sector, the College actively engages in outreach initiatives to support community development and prosperity.

In 2019, the CBA became the first Lebanese university to earn full ACBSP accreditation for all its degrees and programs. This great achievement represents an internationally recognized certificate of rigorous, high-quality education in accordance with international standards and best practices.

Finally, the CBA distinguishes itself by its systematic Co-op Work Experience program, which allows its students to gain real-world work experience, and its Community Engagement Experience program, which enables students to develop leadership skills through hands-on community service.

Vision

The College of Business Administration aims to become the region's premier institution for innovative business education.

Mission

The College of Business Administration aspires to transform students' lives through graduate and undergraduate business education, advance knowledge through applied research, and positively impact society's pursuit of development and prosperity.

We aim to foster an educational culture and environment of innovation and collaboration that enable the development of leaders and professionals who are capable and willing to become agents of principled, ethical, and socially responsible human progress.

The College undertakes its mission within a higher education philosophy that emphasizes proficient technical know-how in a specialized area, reinforced by core knowledge of key business functional areas, and grounded in the fundamentals of liberal arts education.

Core Values

The College of Business Administration is committed to maintaining a system of norms, behaviors, and conduct well-grounded in the following main guiding values:

Academic Freedom of Inquiry
Faculty and students are free to pursue knowledge and learning so long as such pursuits do not breach University and College missions, policies, and regulations.

Excellence through Innovation
The College has an unwavering commitment to pursuing excellence in everything we do. Key to this pursuit are our innovative initiatives, ideas, and efforts.

Ethical and Socially Responsible Conduct
The College makes every effort to ensure awareness of and adherence to ethical and socially responsible norms.

Tolerance and Diversity
The College is committed to highlighting and raising awareness of tolerant mentalities that accept and respect differences with others. Moreover, the College recognizes and promotes the enrichment resulting from diverse individuals, communities, ideas, and perspectives.

Personal Initiative and Individual Responsibility
Leaders and professionals dare to initiate and take responsibility for their choices. The College promotes this principle and encourages its stakeholders to learn and act in accordance with it.

Teamwork, collaboration, and cooperation
The College is committed to conducting its affairs in the spirit of teamwork and collaboration. Furthermore, the College opens opportunities for students to learn and appreciate the value of collective work.

Continuous Improvement and Innovation
The College regards continuous improvement and innovation in its programs and scholarship as necessary to meet the challenges of rapidly changing business environments.

College Learning Goals and Objectives

In line with the College's mission statement, we aim to transform the lives of our students through graduate and undergraduate business education; the College's Learning Objectives specify the expected outcome of this transformation: graduates capable of becoming agents of human progress.

Accordingly, the College's general learning objective is to equip its students with the values, knowledge, competencies, and skills needed to make a positive impact in whatever they do in life. In particular, these values, knowledge, competencies, and skills are as follows:

General and Specialized Knowledge

Knowledge of the main business functional areas (CLG1)	Students will acquire basic knowledge of the main functional areas of business, which is necessary to understand the general business environment and its interrelationships.
Specialized knowledge (CLG2)	Students will become proficient in up-to-date theories, applications, best practices, and other dimensions of their chosen area of specialization, including hands-on applications.

Communication

Effective communication (CLG3)	Students will learn to communicate effectively, orally and in writing, in various professional environments and settings.

Critical Thinking

Analysis and critical thinking (CLG 4)	Programs and activities in the College will involve learning settings that require students to apply analytical and critical thinking tools and methods.

Ethics and Social Responsibility

Ethical and socially responsible conduct (CLG 5)	The college will ensure that its students are exposed to learning opportunities that will allow them to

	improve their recognition and awareness of ethical dilemmas and socially responsible behaviors.

Academic Programs

The College of Business Administration offers six undergraduate programs leading to a Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) degree, two minor programs, and two graduate programs leading to a Master of Business Administration (MBA) degree. The programs are as follows:

1. Bachelor of Business Administration in Accounting
2. Bachelor of Business Administration in Business IT Management
3. Bachelor of Business Administration in Finance and Banking
4. Bachelor of Business Administration in Human Resources Management
5. Bachelor of Business Administration in Management
6. Bachelor of Business Administration in Marketing and Advertising
7. Minor in Business Administration
8. Minor in Human Resources Management
9. Master of Business Administration in General Business Management
10. Master of Business Administration in Oil and Gas Management

Program Codes

The following table lists the code used for each program. This code is the prefix of each course designation in the program.

Program Code	Program
BACC	Accounting
BFIN	Finance and Banking
BADM	General Business Administration
BECN	Economics
BITM	Business IT Management
BMGT	Management
BHRM	Human Resources Management
BMKA	Marketing and Advertising

Admission Requirements

In addition to fulfilling the University admission requirements, students aspiring to study one of the business majors may be required to take a mathematics placement examination, depending on their Lebanese baccalaureate math score. Students who fail to attain a passing score must take and pass one or two related courses, depending on their score, to ensure their mastery of basic skills and improve their ability to handle the rigor of college-level subjects. Students are strongly advised to review the University

Catalog carefully for admission and degree requirements, as well as related academic policies.

Graduation Requirements

Each Business program awards a Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) degree, which comprises 99 credits distributed across three categories: University Requirements (UR), College Requirements (CR), and Program Requirements (PR). The University and College requirements are common to all College of Business Administration programs. Each department has its own required and elective courses. The credit hour allocations for each program are shown in the following tables:

BBA in Accounting (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	6	-	35	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Credits	31	3	53	12	99	100

BBA in Business IT Management (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	3	-	15	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Credits	31	3	53	12	99	100

BBA in Finance and Banking (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	28	3	56	12	99	100

BBA in Human Resources Management (99 Credits)

Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	-	-	41	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	25	3	59	12	99	100

BBA in Management (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	28	3	56	12	99	100

BBA in Marketing and Advertising (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	28	3	56	12	99	100

A business student in any of the programs is eligible for graduation if s/he has:

1) Completed all the requirements of the degree
2) Attained a cumulative GPA of 70% or higher
3) Attained a major GPA of 70% or higher
4) Attained at least a 70% grade in the BADM 490 course
5) Completed the mandatory COOP Work Experience and the Community Engagement Experience.

I. University Requirements (General Education)

Every student is required to take 30 credit hours of general education courses distributed over six domains. Eighteen mandatory credit hours are selected from four domains, and twelve elective credit hours are selected from three domains, as indicated on the following pages.

Domain		Credits	Courses
1	Communication Competency*	8	ENGL 210: English Composition and Rhetoric ENGL 217: Professional English Communication ARAB 212: Arabic Language and Communication
2	Humanities/Fine Arts	3-6	Selected from an approved list
3	Social Sciences/Culture	6	Selected from an approved list
4	Natural Sciences and Technology	6	Natural Sciences: One 3-credit course selected from an approved list. Technology: BITM 200: Information Technology Essentials
5	Quantitative Reasoning	3	BADM 225: Business Math
6	Community and Sustainability	4	BADM 355: Business Ethics and Social Responsibility One 1-credit course selected from an approved list

[1] Non-native Speakers of Arabic are allowed to take either SOCI 310 or CMNS 410 as a substitute for ARAB 212.

Description of the specific courses in this group is given below:

ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2(2,0)
This course helps students develop their ability to communicate effectively in standard Arabic. It provides students with the necessary Arabic communication skills they may need for their future jobs. Specifically, students learn how to write and orally present different forms of workplace documents in Arabic.		

BADM 225	Business Math	3(3,0)
Linear equations, supply and demand analysis, non-linear equations, quadratic functions, exponential and logarithmic functions, compound interest, geometric series, investment appraisal, Derivatives and marginal revenue-cost-profit, elasticity, functions of several variables, partial elasticity and marginal functions, simple optimizations, indefinite and definite integration, matrix operations and Cramer's rule.		

BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the contemporary principles of ethics and social responsibility in business. Students learn to make ethical judgments about important issues they face daily by relating them to a framework of ethical principles, including utilitarianism, justice, moral rights, the ethics of care, and virtues and vices. Ethical dilemmas related to conflicts of interest, sustainability in business strategy, and corporate governance are among the issues discussed in this course. Prerequisite: Junior Standing.		

BITM 200	Information Technology Essentials	3(3,0)

This course is an introduction to the general and business use of computers. It covers the basics of hardware, the operating system, the internet, and software, with an emphasis on the MS Office Suite.

CMNS 200	**Etiquette**	**1(1,0)**
This course is designed to help students develop interpersonal and communication skills that are fundamental to success in the workplace, regardless of the industry, organization, or sector in which they are employed. Students will improve their professional style as they study topics including polite conversation, personal appearance, office politics, diplomacy, telephone, cell phone, and voicemail etiquette, meeting protocol, job interview presentations, and even international travel. Students will participate in an off-campus formal dining experience. **Co-requisite:** ENGL 210.		

CMNS 205	**First Aid**	**1(1,0)**
This course provides an overview of the principles of first aid, including preserving life, preventing further injury, and protecting the unconscious. It enhances students' knowledge of first-aid procedures and their application in real-life situations. The course also helps them develop the skills necessary to assist until medical help arrives. It raises students' awareness of different types of medical emergencies and the appropriate steps to take in both mild and life-threatening conditions. **Co-requisite:** ENGL 210.		

ENGL 210	**English Composition and Rhetoric**	**3(3,0)**
This course reviews the fundamentals of good academic writing in English, teaches essay writing essentials and research skills in two rhetorical modes (persuasion and argumentation), and provides practice in writing essays in these modes, research papers, and oral presentations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 101 or TOEFL 550+ (paper) or 100+ (computer).		

ENGL 217	**Professional English Communication**	**3(3,0)**
This course is designed to help students develop effective professional communication skills, both orally and in writing. In this course, students learn how to write emails, memos, letters, proposals, reports, and other forms of employment correspondence. In addition, this course helps students sharpen their presentation skills. Broadly, this course enables students to behave professionally and effectively in their prospective jobs. **Prerequisite**: ENGL 210.		

II. College Requirements

A. Remedial Courses

Proficiency in the English Language is a requirement for admission to any program in the College of Business Administration. The student may be required to take a remedial mathematics course, depending on the placement exam or the Baccalaureate mathematics score. This remedial course does not count toward fulfilling the degree requirements. A description of the remedial course follows.